

Atlanta Police Department

Patrol Division — Traffic Services
226 Peachtree Street NW, Atlanta, GA 30303

OFFICIAL TRAFFIC COLLISION REPORT

(404) 555-0164 | Emergency: 911

CASE NUMBER	APD-26-09-12-4418	WEATHER	Heavy Rain / Thunderstorm (visibility 400 ft)
DATE OF INCIDENT	September 12, 2026	LIGHT CONDITIONS	Daylight / Storm-darkened
TIME OF INCIDENT	14:07 hrs	ROADWAY SURFACE	Wet / Water ponding
LOCATION	I-285 Eastbound, Mile Marker 31.4 (Buford Highway exit area), Chamblee, GA 30341	TYPE OF COLLISION / VEHICLES	5-vehicle chain collision including commercial van / 5 vehicles

SECTION 1 — RESPONDING UNITS

Responding Agency	Atlanta Police Department
Investigating Officer	Officer Shonda M. Watkins, Badge #8821
Officer Phone	(404) 555-0164 ext. 812
EMS Agency	DeKalb County Fire — Medic 3 and Medic 11 (transported five occupants)
Tow Companies	Peach State Towing (V2, V3, V5); owner (V1, V4)
Additional Units	Sgt. D. Maxwell #4412; GSP Unit 44; GDOT Incident Response

SECTION 2 — VEHICLES

#	Year / Make / Model	VIN	Plate	Damage
V1	2022 Chevrolet Tahoe	1GNSKRKD5PR341801	GA-APX-4418 (GA)	Rear bumper, step deformed — moderate; drivable
V2	2020 Toyota Camry	4T1G11AK1LU181801	GA-BRT-8821 (GA)	Front and rear deformed — sandwiched; both airbags; water ingress severe
V3	2019 Honda Accord	1HGCV1F35KA181801	GA-CTX-3319 (GA)	Front bumper, hood, radiator destroyed; airbag deployed; total loss likely
V4	2021 Ford Explorer	1FMSK7DH6MGA81801	GA-DLM-7723 (GA)	Front bumper, grille — moderate; airbag deployed; drivable with caution
V5	2018 Mercedes-Benz Sprinter (commercial cargo van, CMV)	WD3PE8CDXJP541801	GA-CMV-441 (GA)	Front bumper assembly destroyed; grille, headlights; hood buckled; radiator damaged; CMV out of service

SECTION 3 — DRIVERS / OPERATORS

Party	Name	DOB	License	Citation
Driver V1	James D. Washington	03/18/1980	GA-W44218301	None
Driver V2	Rosa L. Torres	08/27/1986	GA-T88234107	GA OCGA §40-6-49 — Following Too Close
Driver V3	Hamid R. Malik	11/14/1979	GA-M77187213	GA OCGA §40-6-49 — Following Too Close
Driver V4	Chinyere B. Okafor	04/22/1993	GA-O44219801	None
Operator V5 (CMV)	Roy T. Simmons	01/09/1967	GA-CDL-S88241307	GA OCGA §40-6-49 — Following Too Close; FMCSA 49 CFR §392.14 — CMV Hazardous Conditions

SECTION 4 — PASSENGERS

Veh	Name	DOB	Injury	Transported
V2	Diana M. Torres	05/11/1988	Critical: head trauma, loss of consciousness, suspected TBI	Yes — DeKalb Medic 3, to Grady Memorial Hospital Trauma (trauma activation)
V2	Luis G. Torres	09/03/2012	Serious: cervical strain, facial lacerations, airbag burns	Yes — DeKalb Medic 3, to Childrens Healthcare of Atlanta (serious)
V3	Fatima K. Malik	06/19/1982	Moderate: right shoulder fracture (suspected), seat belt chest bruise	Yes — DeKalb Medic 11, to Emory University Hospital (stable)
V4	Obiageli T. Okafor	02/28/2004	Minor: neck stiffness, evaluated — declined transport	No
V1	Marcus R. Washington	07/14/2017	Minor: child safety seat intact; EMS evaluated, no injury apparent	No — parents declined, EMS concurred

SECTION 5 — WITNESSES

#	Name	Address	Phone	Statement
W1	Harold P. Freedman	Motorist stopped safely on right shoulder	(404) 555-0341	Yes — confirmed 5-vehicle sequence; noted V5 approaching fast; written statement
W2	Yolanda T. Cruise	Passenger in vehicle behind V5	(404) 555-0448	Yes — confirmed V5 did not brake until very late; video on phone provided to officer
W3	GDOT Incident Response Supervisor A. Patel	GDOT District 7	(404) 555-0512	Yes — arrived 14:24 hrs; confirmed DMS advisory had been active since 13:41 hrs; GDOT log provided
W4	Reginald M. Brooks	Buford Hwy exit ramp observer	(404) 555-0617	Yes — observed from exit ramp above; described V5 as traveling significantly faster than other traffic; written statement

SECTION 6 — PROPERTY DAMAGE (NON-VEHICLE)

	I-285 EB mile marker sign at 31.3 — struck by V3 post-collision; post bent. GDOT notified. Right shoulder concrete barrier — V5 secondary contact; two panels scraped.
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SECTION 7 — NARRATIVE

On Saturday September 12, 2026 at approximately 14:07 hrs, this officer, Sgt. Maxwell, Georgia State Patrol Unit 44, and GDOT Incident Response were dispatched to I-285 eastbound at Mile Marker 31.4 near the Buford Highway exit in Chamblee on report of a five-vehicle chain collision with multiple injuries including a commercial vehicle. A heavy thunderstorm was active at the time of the incident, with rainfall intense enough to pond in the right lane near the exit ramp drainage area. Visibility was estimated at approximately 400 feet. V1 (2022 Chevrolet Tahoe, Washington) was traveling eastbound in the center lane at a reduced speed appropriate for the storm conditions and slowed for traffic backing up ahead of the Buford Highway exit. V2 (2020 Toyota Camry, Torres) was following V1 and struck V1's rear at an estimated 40 mph in the ponding rain conditions. V2 came to rest blocking the center and right lanes. V3 (2019 Honda Accord, Malik) struck the rear of V2 with greater force, deploying V3's airbag and pushing V2 into V1 a second time. V4 (2021 Ford Explorer, Okafor) was following V3 and, after brief emergency braking, struck V3's rear at reduced speed. V5 (2018 Mercedes-Benz Sprinter commercial cargo van, operator Simmons — Peachtree Delivery Services LLC) was the final and most severe rear-impact. Witness Brooks, observing from the Buford Highway exit ramp above the incident location, described V5 as traveling markedly faster than surrounding traffic and as showing no brake lights until approximately two seconds before impact. V5 struck V4's rear and pushed V4 into V3, adding a fifth compression to the accordion. The impact force of V5 on V4 was significant, consistent with a CMV traveling near highway speed into a stationary or near-stationary vehicle grouping. Witness Yolanda Cruise provided mobile phone video (approximately 41 seconds) capturing the final two impacts (V4 into V3, then V5 into V4). The video is in evidence under Evidence Reference EV-4418-A. GDOT Incident Response Supervisor Patel confirmed the dynamic message sign at Mile Marker 28.1 had been displaying "HEAVY RAIN — REDUCE SPEED" since 13:41 hrs — 26 minutes before the collision. CMV operator Simmons's speed at impact is being assessed by Det. Reynolds (Traffic Unit) based on V5 EDR data request. V2 passenger Diana Torres was transported in critical condition to Grady Memorial Hospital Trauma Center under trauma activation protocol with head trauma and suspected TBI. V2 passenger Luis Torres, age 14, was transported in serious condition to Children's Healthcare of Atlanta with cervical strain and facial lacerations. V3 passenger Fatima Malik was transported with a suspected right shoulder fracture to Emory University Hospital. V4 passenger Obiageli Okafor (age 22) evaluated on scene, declined transport with neck stiffness. V1 passenger Marcus Washington, age 8 (child safety seat intact), was evaluated by EMS with no injury found; parents declined transport. CMV operator Simmons was uninjured and declined transport. V5 was placed out of service.

SECTION 9 — SUPPLEMENTAL INVESTIGATION NOTES

SUPPLEMENTAL — CMV INVESTIGATION AND TRAFFIC UNIT REFERRAL: V5 (Mercedes-Benz Sprinter, Peachtree Delivery Services LLC, USDOT #2941182) was placed out of service per FMCSA 49 CFR §396.9 at 15:02 hrs. GSP Motor Carrier Officer T. Hammond arrived at 15:19 hrs and initiated a Level II inspection. Preliminary findings: tires within spec; brakes within spec; cargo secured (general freight — no hazmat). Operator Simmons's hours-of-service records (paper logbook) reviewed on scene; showed 7.2 hours driving in the preceding 12 hours, within limits. Full inspection report (GSP Form CMV-22) is pending and will be attached as Exhibit B. EDR REQUEST: V5 EDR download requested by Det. Reynolds (#7741, APDU Traffic Fatality/Serious Injury Unit). If V5 EDR data confirms speed above 65 mph at impact, additional charges under GA OCGA §40-6-390 (Reckless Driving) will be considered. Results pending. CHILD SAFETY SEAT: Marcus Washington (V1, age 8) was in a high-back booster seat. The seat sustained no visible deformation but was involved in a moderate crash (V1 rear-struck twice). Replacement recommended per NHTSA; resource sheet provided to Washington family. DIANA TORRES MEDICAL UPDATE: Grady Memorial Trauma confirmed receipt of patient at 14:38 hrs. CT imaging revealed subdural hematoma (small, non-surgical). Patient was admitted to neurosurgical ICU in critical but stable condition as of 17:00 hrs. Medical update requested from Grady within 24 hours. I-285 CLOSURE: Full EB closure at Exit 30 from 14:22 to 17:11 hrs. GDOT diverted to GA-400 southbound. TIM log attached as Exhibit A.

SECTION 10 — CITATIONS / CHARGES SUMMARY

Party	Statute	Violation	Fine / Disposition
Driver V2 (Torres)	GA OCGA §40-6-49	Following Too Close — heavy rain	Civil Penalty
Driver V3 (Malik)	GA OCGA §40-6-49	Following Too Close — heavy rain	Civil Penalty
Operator V5 (Simmons)	GA OCGA §40-6-49	Following Too Close — CMV/heavy rain	Civil Penalty
Operator V5 (Simmons)	49 CFR §392.14	CMV Operation in Hazardous Conditions	Federal — FMCSA
Operator V5 (Simmons)	GA OCGA §40-6-390	Reckless Driving — pending EDR confirmation	Under Review

SECTION 8 — OFFICER SIGN-OFF

signed

Officer Shonda M. Watkins, Badge #8821

Investigating Officer, Atlanta Police Department Traffic Services

September 12, 2026

Date